

Lion -- Elevation Worship (CCM / Modern Worship)

HSS Stratocaster. Full board.

Album-level build, modeled on the overall guitar approach across Elevation Worship's *Lion* (2022) and their wider catalog -- the modern CCM "wall of sound": ambient, heavily modulated clean tones under verses, swelling into a bigger, saturated anthem tone for choruses and lead lines, all of it soaked in delay and reverb the whole time.

That wash never goes away between the two states -- only the gain does. That's the core design decision here: MOD/DLY/RVB/EQ/AMP stay fixed and always on, CTL only swaps the gain stages.

GP-5 Settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB

AMP/CAB -- uses an IR for CAB

- AMP: **Dark Twin** (Fender 65 Twin Reverb) -- Gain 35, VOL 65, Bass 50, Middle 60, Treble 55, Bright off.
- IR: **American Twin 2x12 Medium Mix** (from `IRs/ir.md`) -- the suggested pairing for Dark Twin in that file. Medium blend chosen specifically because this cab has to work for both CTL states: Bright Mix would get brittle once the drive stages kick in for the anthem state, Dark Mix would dull the ambient clean shimmer too much.
- `CAB` is off (`model: null`) in the `.prst`, same reasoning as a NAM: no way to know which of the 20 `User IR` slots this file is sitting in on the device, or whether it's loaded at all right now. Load **American Twin 2x12 Medium Mix** into a `User IR` slot in Valetton Suite and point the device's CAB block at it before using this patch.
- Bright switch on the amp itself is left off -- the American Twin IR (JBL D120F) is already a hi-fi, extended-top-end speaker; stacking the amp's own bright switch on top would get harsh once EQ and the 6kHz lift are added downstream.

NR -- Gate

- THRE: 20
- Always on. Light -- this patch lives on long decaying swells and delay/reverb tails, so the gate can't be aggressive enough to chop them off.

PRE -- Boost (Xotic EP Booster)

- Gain: 60, +3dB: On, Bright: On
- **CTL switch.** Off = bypassed, On = engaged.
- The "size" switch for the anthem state -- clean, transparent volume/edge boost that pushes the amp and DST harder without adding its own character. Off for the ambient rhythm sound, on for the lead/chorus lift.

DST -- Green OD (Tube Screamer / TS-808)

- Gain: 40, Tone: 60, VOL: 65
- **CTL switch.** Off = bypassed, On = engaged.
- Moderate, not metal -- this is the smooth, singing mid-gain crunch that defines the modern worship

"anthem" guitar tone, not a rock distortion. Off for rhythm, on for lead, stacking with the Boost and the King of Kings right channel (see pedalboard) for the full swell.

EQ -- Guitar EQ 2

- 100Hz: -3, 500Hz: -2, 1kHz: 0, 3kHz: +4, 6kHz: +5, VOL: 50
- Always on. Low end trimmed so the guitar doesn't fight bass/pads in a dense worship mix; slight 500Hz cut to keep it out of the boxy zone; 3kHz/6kHz lifted for the airy, cutting shimmer that sits on top of a big band mix without needing raw volume.

MOD -- A-Chorus (Arion SCH-1)

- Depth: 55, Rate: 0.6Hz, Tone: 60
- Always on, both CTL states. Heavier than this workflow's usual light-touch MOD default -- deliberately, because a drenched, obvious chorus shimmer is the whole point of this style, not an accident. This is doing a lot of the "ambient wall" work by itself.

DLY -- Tape

- Mix: 35, Time: 450ms, F.Back: 35, Trail: On
- Always on, both CTL states. Long, warm, saturated repeats -- this genre's guitar sound is inseparable from delay. Same delay under both the quiet rhythm parts and the big lead swells, which is exactly how these records are built.

RVB -- Sweet Space

- Mix: 40, Decay: 70, Damp: 40, Mod: 35, Trail: On
- Always on, both CTL states. Long, modulated, spacious reverb -- the Mod parameter adds a subtle shimmer/movement to the tail that's very characteristic of this modern-CCM ambient sound. This is the "room" the whole track lives in.

CTL Summary (GP-5)

- **CTL Off -- Rhythm (verses, ambient sections):** Clean Dark Twin/American Twin tone, no PRE boost, no drive. The wash (chorus/delay/reverb) carries the sound. This is the main texture of the patch.
- **CTL On -- Lead (choruses, anthem sections):** Boost + Green OD both kick in on top of the same amp/cab/wash, pushing into a bigger, saturated, sustained tone -- same ambient character, just louder and driven. Pair with the King of Kings right channel for the full swell.

Full Pedalboard (signal chain order)

1. Flamma FS-08 Octave -- Engaged, light shimmer layer, whole song.

- +OCT: 25, all other octave knobs (-2OCT, -OCT, +2OCT): 0
- Dry: 80

A subtle octave-up layer underneath the dry signal -- this is a real Elevation Worship production trick, a quiet shimmer pad sitting under the clean arpeggios. Kept low enough (+OCT 25) that it reads as texture, not a separate voice. Since it's polyphonic and best on sustained material, it works well here because this patch is built around sustained chords and swells, not fast lead runs.

2. Donner Ultimate Comp -- Engaged, whole song.

- COMP: 50
- TONE: 55
- LEVEL: 55
- Mode: NORMAL

Evens out dynamics for sustained ambient swells -- critical for this style, where notes need to bloom and hold evenly under all that delay/reverb. NORMAL mode (not TREBLE) because the EQ module and MOD/DLY/RVB chain already add plenty of top end; stacking more brightness pre-drive would get harsh once the Boost/Green OD kick in.

3. Donner Stylish Fuzz -- Bypassed, whole song.

Not a fuzz style -- the anthem lift comes from smooth, singing overdrive (Boost + Green OD + King of Kings), not garage fuzz character. True bypass throughout.

4. Joyo King of Kings -- Left channel engaged whole song, Right channel engaged only for CTL On / lead sections.

Left channel (always on -- low-gain glue):

- Volume: 55
- Gain: 20
- Tone: 55
- Clipping toggle: softer setting
- Feedback toggle: standard setting

A quiet, always-on push that adds warmth and a little extra harmonic content under the clean ambient tone -- very common in modern worship rigs, an always-on low-gain stage that "glues" the tone even before anything else engages.

Right channel (CTL On / lead only):

- Volume: 65
- Gain: 55
- Tone: 60
- Clipping toggle: harder setting
- Feedback toggle: higher setting

Stacks with the left channel, the GP-5's Boost, and Green OD for the full anthem swell -- this is the extra saturation and sustain that makes the chorus/lead sections feel huge without turning harsh. Step on together with the GP-5 CTL switch.

5. Joyo Narcissus -- Bypassed, whole song.

The GP-5's own A-Chorus (always on) is the primary chorus/shimmer voice for this patch, already pushed harder than usual on purpose. Stacking a second chorus pedal on top would turn the wash to mud. True bypass throughout.

6. Valeton GP-5 -- as detailed above.

Footswitch Choreography

- **Rhythm / verses / ambient sections:** GP-5 CTL off, King of Kings right channel off. Comp and Octave shimmer running underneath the whole time.
- **Chorus / lead / anthem sections:** GP-5 CTL on (engages PRE Boost + Green OD together) at the same moment you step on the King of Kings right channel. All three come off together when dropping back to a verse/rhythm section.
- Fuzz and Narcissus stay bypassed for the entire patch -- the wash comes from the GP-5's own MOD/DLY/RVB, not from stacking extra modulation/fuzz pedals.